Developmental Milestones for Developmental Surveillance at Preventive Care Visits

Developmental milestones are intended for discussion with parents for the purposes of surveillance of a child's developmental progress and for developmental promotion for the child. They are not intended or validated for use as a developmental screening test in the pediatric medical home or in early childhood day care or educational settings. Milestones are also commonly used for instructional purposes on early child development for pediatric and child development professional trainees.

Age	Social language and self-help	Verbal language (Expressive and receptive)	Gross Motor	Fine Motor
Newborn – 1 Week	Makes brief eye contact	Cries with discomfort Calms to adult voice	Reflexively moves arms and legs Turns head to side when on stomach	Holds fingers closed Grasps reflexively
1 Month	Calms when picked up or spoken to Looks briefly at objects	Alerts to unexpected sound Makes brief short vowel sounds	Holds chin up in prone	Holds fingers more open at rest
2 Months	Smiles responsively (ie, social smile)	Vocalizes with simple cooing	Lifts head and chest in prone	Opens and shuts hands
4 Months	Laughs aloud	Turns to voice Vocalizes with extended cooing	Rolls over prone to supine Supports on elbows and wrists in prone	Keeps hands unfisted Plays with fingers in midline Grasps object
6 Months	Pats or smiles at reflection Begins to turn when name called	Babbles	Rolls over supine to prone Sits briefly without support	Reaches for objects and transfers Rakes small object with 4 fingers Bangs small object on surface
9 Months	Uses basic gestures (eg, holds arms out to be picked up, waves "bye-bye") Looks for dropped objects Picks up food with fingers and eats it Turns when name called	Says "Dada" or "Mama" nonspecifically	Sits well without support Pulls to stand Transitions well between sitting and lying Balances on hands and knees Crawls	Picks up small object with 3 fingers and thumb Releases objects intentionally Bangs objects together

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Bright Futures Milestones and Anticipatory Guidance

Age	Social language and self-help	Verbal language (Expressive and receptive)	Gross Motor	Fine Motor
12 Months	Looks for hidden objects Imitates new gestures	Says, "Dad" or "Mom" with meaning Uses 1 word other than *Mom* or *Dad*, or personal names Follows a verbal command that includes a gesture	Takes first independent steps Stands without support	Drops object in a cup Picks up small object with 2-finger pincer grasp Picks up food and eats it
15 Months	Imitates scribbling Drinks from cup with little spilling Points to ask for something or to get help	Uses 3 words other than names Speaks in sounds that seem like an unknown language Follows directions that do not include a gesture Looks around when parent says, "Where is…?"	Squats to pick up objects Crawls up a few steps Begins to run	Makes mark with crayon Drops object into and takes object out of container
18 Months	Engages with others for play Helps dress and undress self Points to pictures in book Points to object of interest to draw attention to it Turns and looks at adult if something new happens Begins to scoop with spoon	Uses 6 to 10 words other than names Identifies at least 2 body parts	Walks up with 2 feet per step with hand held Sits in small chair Carries toy while walking	Scribbles spontaneously Throws small ball a few feet while standing

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Bright Futures Milestones and Anticipatory Guidance

Age	Social language and self-help	Verbal language (Expressive and receptive)	Gross Motor	Fine Motor
2 Years	Plays alongside other children Takes off some clothing Scoops well with spoon	Uses 50 words Combines 2 words into phrase or sentence Follows 2-step command Uses words that are 50% intelligible to strangers	Kicks ball Jumps off ground with 2 feet Runs with coordination Climbs up a ladder at a playground	Stacks objects Turns book pages Uses hands to turn objects (eg, knobs, toys, lids)
2½ Years	Urinates in a potty or toilet Plays pretend with toys or dolls Pokes food with fork	Uses pronouns correctly Explains the reasons for things, such as needing a sweater when it's cold Names at least one color	Walks up steps, using one foot, then the other Runs well without falling	Grasps crayon with thumb and fingers instead of fist Catches a large ball Copies a vertical line
3 Years	Goes to the bathroom and urinates by self Plays and shares with others Puts on coat, jacket, or shirt by self Begins to play make-believe Eats independently	Uses 3-word sentences Uses words that are 75% intelligible to strangers Understands simple prepositions (eg, *on, under*) Tells a story from a book or TV Compares things using words such as *bigger* or *shorter*	Pedals tricycle Climbs on and off couch or chair Jumps forward	Draws a single circle Draws a person with head and one other body part Cuts with child scissors

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Bright Futures Milestones and Anticipatory Guidance

Age	Social language and self-help	Verbal language (Expressive and receptive)	Gross Motor	Fine Motor
4 Years	Enters bathroom and has bowel movement by self Dresses and undresses without much help Plays make-believe	Uses 4-word sentences Uses words that are 100% intelligible to strangers Answers questions Tells a story from a book	Climbs stairs, alternating feet without support Skips on one foot	Draws a person with at least 3 body parts Draws a simple cross Unbuttons and buttons medium-sized buttons Grasps a pencil with thumb and fingers instead of fist Draws recognizable pictures
5 Years	Spreads with a knife Dresses and undresses without help Goes to bathroom independently Is dry through the day Plays and interacts with peers Answers “why” questions	Tells a story of 2 sentences or more Follows directions for 4 individual prepositions Counts 5 objects Names 3 or more numbers Names 4 or more letters out of order	Is beginning to skip Walks on tiptoes when asked Catches a bounced ball with 2 hands	Copies a triangle Draws a 6-part person Copies first name Cuts well with scissors Writes 2 or more letters
6 Years	Cuts most foods with a knife Ties shoes Is dry day and night Chooses preferred foods Starts/continues conversations with peers Plays and interacts with at least one “best friend”	Tells a story with a beginning, a middle, and an end Masters all consonant sounds and combinations, such as “d” or “ch” Counts 10 objects Can do simple addition and subtraction with objects	Rides a standard bike Hops on one foot 3 to 4 times Catches small ball with 2 hands	Draws a 12-part person Prints 3 or more simple words without copying Writes first and last names in uppercase or lowercase letters

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Bright Futures Milestones and Anticipatory Guidance

Age	Development
7 and 8 Years	Shows the ability to get along with others and control emotions Chooses to eat healthy foods and participate in physical activity every day Forms caring, supportive relationships with family members, other adults, and peers
9 and 10 Years	Shows the ability to get along with others and control emotions Chooses to eat healthy foods and participate in physical activity every day Forms caring, supportive relationships with family members, other adults, and peers
11 Through 14 Years	Forms caring, supportive relationships with family members, other adults, and peers Engages in a positive way with the life of the community Engages in behaviors that optimize wellness and contribute to a healthy lifestyle • Engages in healthy nutrition and physical activity behaviors • Chooses safety Demonstrates physical, cognitive, emotional, social, and moral competencies Exhibits compassion and empathy Exhibits resilience when confronted with life stressors Uses independent decision-making skills Displays a sense of self-confidence, hopefulness, and well-being
15 Through 17 Years	Forms caring, supportive relationships with family members, other adults, and peers Engages in a positive way with the life of the community Engages in behaviors that optimize wellness and contribute to a healthy lifestyle • Engages in healthy nutrition and physical activity behaviors • Chooses safety Demonstrates physical, cognitive, emotional, social, and moral competencies Exhibits compassion and empathy Exhibits resilience when confronted with life stressors Uses independent decision-making skills Displays a sense of self-confidence, hopefulness, and well-being
18 Through 21 Years	Forms caring, supportive relationships with family members, other adults, and peers Engages in a positive way with the life of the community Engages in behaviors that optimize wellness and contribute to a healthy lifestyle • Engages in healthy nutrition and physical activity behaviors • Chooses safety Demonstrates physical, cognitive, emotional, social, and moral competencies Exhibits compassion and empathy Exhibits resilience when confronted with life stressors Uses independent decision-making skills Displays a sense of self-confidence, hopefulness, and well-being

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Anticipatory Guidance for Preventive Care Visits

Age	Social determinants of health	Parent and family health	Nutrition and feeding	Newborn behavior and care	Safety
Newborn – 1 Week	Living situation and food security Environmental tobacco exposure Family support	Transition home and sibling adjustment	General feeding guidance Breast/formula-feeding guidance	Early brain development; calming When to call; CPR; illness prevention	Car safety seats Safe sleep Heatstroke prevention Burn prevention
Age	**Social determinants of health**	**Parent and family health**	**Nutrition and feeding**	**Infant behavior and development**	**Safety**
1 Month	Living situation and food security Environmental tobacco exposure Dampness and mold, radon, and pesticides Intimate partner violence Maternal alcohol and substance use Family support	Postpartum checkup Maternal depression Family relationships	Feeding plans and choices General guidance on feeding Breastfeeding or formula-feeding guidance	Sleeping and waking Fussiness and attachment Media Playtime Medical home after-hours support	Car safety seats Safe sleep Preventing falls Emergency care
Age	**Social determinants of health**	**Parent and family health**	**Nutrition and feeding**	**Infant behavior and development**	**Safety**
2 Month	Living situation and food security Family support Child care	Postpartum checkup Maternal depression Sibling relationships	General guidance on feeding and delaying solid foods Hunger and satiety cues Breastfeeding or formula-feeding guidance	Parent-infant relationship Parent-infant communications Sleeping Media Playtime Fussiness	Car safety seats Safe sleep Safe home environment: burns, drowning, and falls

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Bright Futures Milestones and Anticipatory Guidance

Age	Social determinants of health	Oral health	Nutrition and feeding	Infant behavior and development	Safety
4 Month	Environmental risk: lead Family relationships and support Child care	Maternal oral health Teething and drooling Good oral hygiene	General guidance on feeding Feeding choices Delaying solid foods Breastfeeding or formula-feeding guidance Supplements and over-the-counter medications	Infant self-calming Parent-infant communication Consistent daily routines Media Playtime	Car safety seats Safe sleep Safe home environment
Age	**Social determinants of health**	**Oral health**	**Nutrition and feeding**	**Infant behavior and development**	**Safety**
6 Month	Living situation and food security Tobacco, alcohol, and drug use Parental depression Family relationships and support Child care	Fluoride Oral hygiene/soft toothbrush Avoidance of bottle in bed	General guidance on feeding Solid foods Pesticides in vegetables and fruits Fluids and juice Breast or formula-feeding guidance	Parents as teachers Communication and early literacy Media Emerging infant independence Putting self to sleep Self-calming	Car safety seats Safe sleep Safe home environment: burns, sun exposure, choking, poisoning, drowning, and falls
Age	**Social determinants of health**	**Discipline**	**Nutrition and feeding**	**Infant behavior and development**	**Safety**
9 Month	Intimate partner violence Family relationships and support	Parent expectation of infant's behavior	Self-feeding Mealtime routines Transition to solid foods Cup drinking Plans for weaning	Changing sleep patterns Developmental mobility and cognitive development Interactive learning and communication Media	Car safety seats Heatstroke prevention Firearm safety Safe home environment: burns, poisoning, drowning, and falls

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Bright Futures Milestones and Anticipatory Guidance

Age	Social determinants of health	Establishing a dental home	Establishing routines	Feeding and appetite changes	Safety
12 Month	Living situation and food security Tobacco, alcohol, and drug use Social connections with family and others	First dental checkup and dental hygiene	Adjustment to development changes and behavior Family time Bedtime, nap time, and teeth brushing Media	Self-feeding Continued breastfeeding; transition to family meals Nutritious foods	Car safety seats Falls Drowning prevention and water safety Sun protection Pets Poisoning
Age	**Communication and social development**	**Temperament, development, behavior, and discipline**	**Sleep routines and issues**	**Healthy teeth**	**Safety**
15 Month	Individuation Separation Finding support Attention to how child communicates wants and interests	Conflict predictors and distraction Discipline and behavior management	Regular bedtime routine Night waking No bottle in bed	Brushing teeth Reducing caries	Car safety seats and parental use of seat belts Safe home environment: poisoning, falls, and fire safety
Age	**Communication and social development**	**TV viewing and digital media**	**Temperament, development, toilet training, behavior, and discipline**	**Healthy nutrition**	**Safety**
18 Month	Encouragement of language Use of simple words and phrases Engagement in reading, playing, talking, and singing	Promotion of reading Physical activity and safe play	Anticipation of return to separation anxiety and managing behavior with consistent limits Recognizing signs of toilet-training readiness and parental expectations New sibling planned or on the way	Nutritious foods; water, milk, and juice Expressing independence through food likes and dislikes	Car safety seats and parental use of seat belts Poisoning Sun protection Gun safety Safe home environment: burns, fires, and falls

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Age	Social determinants of health	Toilet training	Temperament and behavior	Assessment of language development	Safety
2 Year	Intimate partner violence Living situation and food security Tobacco, alcohol, and drug use Parental well-being	Techniques Personal hygiene	Development Temperament Promotion of physical activity and safe play Limits on media use	How child communicates and expectations for language Promotion of reading	Car safety seats Outdoor safety Gun safety
Age	**Family routines**	**Language promotion and communication**	**Promoting social development**	**Preschool considerations**	**Safety**
2½ Year	Day and evening routines Enjoyable family activities Parental activities outside the family Consistency in the child's environment	Use of simple words and reading together	Play with other children Giving choices Limits on TV and media use	Readiness for early childhood programs and playgroups Toilet training	Car safety seats Outdoor safety Water safety Sun protection Fire and burns
Age	**Social determinants of health**	**Playing with siblings and peers**	**Encouraging literacy activities**	**Promoting healthy nutrition and physical activity**	**Safety**
3 Year	Living situation and food security Tobacco, alcohol, and drug use Positive family interactions Work-life balance	Play opportunities and interactive games Sibling relationships	Reading, talking, and singing together Language development	Water, milk, and juice Nutritious foods Competence in motor skills and limits on inactivity	Car safety seats Choking prevention Pedestrian safety and falls from windows Water safety Pets Gun safety

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Bright Futures Milestones and Anticipatory Guidance

Age	Social determinants of health	Developing healthy nutrition and personal habits	School readiness	Media use	Safety
4 Year	Living situation and food security Tobacco, alcohol, and drug use Intimate partner violence Safety in the community Engagement in the community	Water, milk, and juice Nutritious foods Daily routines that promote health	Language understanding and fluency Feelings Opportunities to socialize with other children Readiness for structured learning experiences Early childhood programs and preschool	Limits on use Promoting physical activity and safe play	Belt-positioning car booster seats Outdoor safety Water safety Sun protection Pets Gun safety
Age	**Social determinants of health**	**Development and mental health**	**School**	**Physical growth and development**	**Safety**
5 Years	Neighborhood and family violence Food security Family substance use Emotional security and self-esteem Connectedness with family	Family rules and routines, concern for others, and respect for others Patience and control over anger	Readiness, established routines, school attendance, and friends After-school care and activities; parent-teacher communication	Oral health Nutrition Physical activity	Car safety Outdoor safety Water safety Sun protection Harm from adults Home fire safety Gun safety
Age	**Social determinants of health**	**Development and mental health**	**School**	**Physical growth and development**	**Safety**
6 Years	Neighborhood and family violence Food security Family substance use Emotional security and self-esteem Connectedness with family	Family rules and routines, concern for others, and respect for others Patience and control over anger	Readiness, established routines, school attendance, and friends After-school care and activities; parent-teacher communication	Oral health Nutrition Physical activity	Car safety Outdoor safety Water safety Sun protection Harm from adults Home fire safety Gun safety

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Age	Social determinants of health	Development and mental health	School	Physical growth and development	Safety
7 and 8 Years	Neighborhood and family violence Food security Family substance use Harm from the Internet Emotional security and self-esteem Connectedness with family and peers	Independence Rules and consequences Temper problems and conflict resolution Puberty and pubertal development	Adaptation to school School problems (behavior or learning issues) School performance and progress; school attendance IEP or special education services Involvement in school activities and after-school programs	Oral health Nutrition Physical activity	Car safety Safety during physical activity Water safety Sun protection Harm from adults Gun safety
Age	**Social determinants of health**	**Development and mental health**	**School**	**Physical growth and development**	**Safety**
9 and 10 Years	Neighborhood and family violence Food security Family substance use Harm from the Internet Emotional security and self-esteem Connectedness with family and peers	Temper problems, setting reasonable limits, and friends Sexuality	School attendance School problems School performance and progress Transitions Co-occurrence of middle school and pubertal transitions	Oral health Nutrition Physical activity	Car safety Safety during physical activity Water safety Sun protection Knowing child's friends and their families Gun safety

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Bright Futures Milestones and Anticipatory Guidance

Age	Social determinants of health	Development and mental health	Physical growth and development	Emotional well-being	Risk Reduction	Safety
11 Through 14 Years	Interpersonal violence Living situation and food security Family substance use Connectedness with family, peers, and community School performance Coping with stress and decision-making	Family rules and routines, concern for others, and respect for others Patience and control over anger	Oral health Body image Healthy eating Physical activity and sleep	Mood regulation and mental health Sexuality	Pregnancy and sexually transmitted infections Tobacco, e-cigarettes, alcohol, and prescription or street drugs Acoustic trauma	Seat belt and helmet use Sun protection Substance use and riding in a vehicle Firearm safety
Age	**Social determinants of health**	**Development and mental health**	**Physical growth and development**	**Emotional well-being**	**Risk Reduction**	**Safety**
15 Through 17 Years	Interpersonal violence Living situation and food security Family substance use Connectedness with family, peers, and community School performance Coping with stress and decision-making	Family rules and routines, concern for others, and respect for others Patience and control over anger	Oral health Body image Healthy eating Physical activity and sleep	Mood regulation and mental health Sexuality	Pregnancy and sexually transmitted infections Tobacco, e-cigarettes, alcohol, and prescription or street drugs Acoustic trauma	Seat belt and helmet use Sun protection Substance use and riding in a vehicle Firearm safety

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Age	Social determinants of health	Development and mental health	Physical growth and development	Emotional well-being	Risk Reduction	Safety
18 Through 21 Years	Interpersonal violence Living situation and food security Family substance use Connectedness with family, peers, and community School performance Coping with stress and decision-making	Family rules and routines, concern for others, and respect for others Patience and control over anger	Oral health Body image Healthy eating Physical activity and sleep Transition to adult care	Mood regulation and mental health Sexuality	Pregnancy and sexually transmitted infections Tobacco, e-cigarettes, alcohol, and prescription or street drugs Acoustic trauma	Seat belt and helmet use Sun protection Driving and substance use Firearm safety

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